Toronto Metropolitan University

Metropolitan Undergraduate Engineering Society

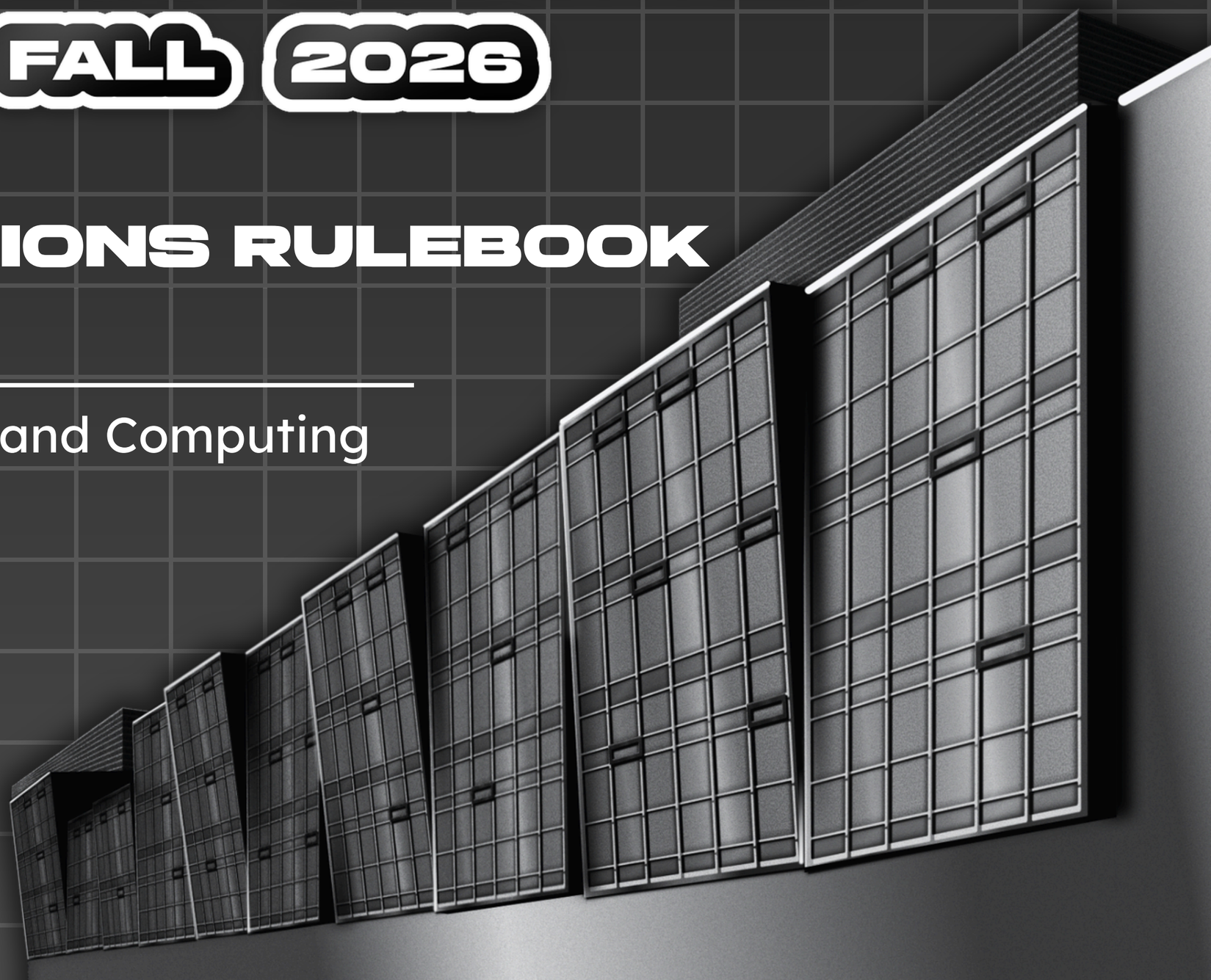
TORONTO METROPOLITAN UNIVERSITY ENGINEERING COMPETITION

FALL 2026

COMMUNICATIONS RULEBOOK

NOVEMBER 7 & 8, 2026

George Vari Engineering and Computing Centre



1.1 OVERVIEW

1.1.1 The goal of the Engineering Communications competition is to communicate an organizer-approved engineering project clearly, accurately, and effectively to a non-technical public audience. For Fall 2026, competitors will present the Toronto Community Food Access and Smart Distribution Network under the theme “Feeding the Future: Designing Smart Infrastructure for Urban Food Security.” The approved engineering solution must be explained, not redesigned or replaced.

1.1.2 The maximum number of individuals for an Engineering Communications team is two (2). Both competitors are expected to participate meaningfully in the presentation.

1.2 TOPIC & PROJECT ELIGIBILITY

1.2.1 Teams must present the organizer-approved engineering project described in the MEC 2026 Engineering Communication Participant Competition Package. The presentation shall explain:

a. The community problem, project purpose, main components, and operation;

b. The approved budget, implementation timeline, and expected social, environmental, and economic impacts; and

c. Relevant risks, limitations, safeguards, maintenance considerations, and trade-offs.

1.2.2 Competitors may conduct supporting research, but must distinguish such information from the approved project details. Project specifications, costs, implementation details, and performance results must not be fabricated or altered. Outcomes beyond the approved information must be identified as estimates, assumptions, or possibilities.

1.2.3 Recommendations for future improvement may be discussed only when clearly distinguished from the approved project. Proposing a replacement engineering solution is not permitted.

1.3 DELIVERABLES

1.3.1 A Presentation Abstract must be submitted prior to the competition. The abstract is mandatory, but does not receive a separate numerical score. The abstract must:

a. Be a maximum of two hundred (200) words and one (1) page;

b. Use 12-point font, one-inch margins, and 1.5 line spacing;

c. Summarize the approved project and the team’s planned communication of its purpose, operation, impacts, and key considerations; and

d. Include the team name and both competitors’ names, and be submitted as a PDF.

1.3.2 A PDF copy of the Presentation Slides must also be submitted. The slides must identify the team name and both competitors, use appropriate citations for external sources, and explain the approved project to a non-technical audience.

1.3.3 Both documents must be submitted through the official Engineering Communication Google Form by Friday, November 6, 2026, at 11:59 PM Eastern Time. File names must follow one of the naming conventions provided in the official pre-competition email.

1.4 FACILITIES AND EQUIPMENT

1.4.1 Engineering Communications is a prepared presentation competition. Deliverables are due before MEC; teams present and answer questions on Sunday, November 8, 2026. Presentation times and room assignments will be provided at check-in. The presentation order will be randomized and cannot be changed.

1.4.2 The following resources will be provided during the presentation phase:

a. One (1) presentation room;

b. One (1) computer for the submitted presentation file; and

c. One (1) digital projector.

1.4.3 Teams requesting additional equipment or accommodations must contact the Competition Coordinators in advance. Competitors are responsible for ensuring their submitted presentation files are compatible with the available equipment.

1.5 EXTERNAL RESOURCES

1.5.1 Competitors may use supporting research and appropriate presentation visuals, provided external sources are properly cited and the approved engineering information is represented accurately.

1.5.2 AI-assisted preparation is permitted only in accordance with the applicable MEC AI policy. Competitors remain responsible for the accuracy and originality of their work.

1.5.3 Presentations must be professional, respectful, and suitable for a non-technical public audience. All competition-day instructions communicated by MEC organizers must be followed.

1.6 COMPETITION DURATIONS

1.6.1 Competition Date: Sunday, November 8, 2026.

1.6.2 Presentation Duration: a maximum of twenty (20) minutes, using the slides submitted before the competition.

1.6.3 Question Period Duration: five (5) minutes immediately following the presentation. Judges will act as non-technical community stakeholders.

1.7 RUBRIC

The Engineering Communications competition will be scored out of one hundred (100) points using the official 2026 scorecard.

Technical Accuracy & Project Understanding	• Accurately explains the approved engineering project and its key technical components (/10) • Explains how the stations, sensors, monitoring platform and pickup system work together, including monitoring-only backup power and operational limitations (/10)	/20
Communication & Audience Awareness	• Clearly explains technical concepts in plain, understandable language (/10) • Uses an appropriate tone and level of detail for a non-technical public audience (/10)	/20
Impacts, Risks & Trade-offs	• Explains environmental, social/community and economic impacts, distinguishing supported information from assumptions (/10) • Explains risks, limitations, safeguards, maintenance considerations and trade-offs (/10)	/20
Presentation & Visual Communication	• Clear, confident, logically structured and within the allotted time (/10) • Visuals support understanding of the project (/10)	/20
Community Q&A	• Accurate, clear and relevant answers to judges' questions (/10) • Professional responses to concerns, acknowledging limitations without unauthorized design changes (/10)	/20
Deductions	• Absent Team Member: –25 • Documents Submitted After Deadline: –25 • Missing or Inadequate Source Citations: –50 • Plagiarism: –50	
Total		/100